Maxim Romanov

Emmy Noether Junior Research Group Leader, DFG project "The Evolution of Islamic Societies (c. 600–1600 CE): Algorithmic Analysis into Social History" (**EIS1600**), Universität Hamburg, Asien-Afrika-Institut

Position *Emmy Noether Junior Research Group Leader*, DFG project "The Evolution of Islamic Societies (c. 600–1600 CE): Algorithmic Analysis into Social History" (**EIS1600**), Universität Hamburg, Asien-Afrika-Institut

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Employment

2021–2027 *Emmy Noether Junior Research Group Leader*, DFG project "The Evolution of Islamic Societies (c. 600–1600 CE): Algorithmic Analysis into Social History" (EIS1600), Universität Hamburg, Asien-Afrika-Institut

2018–2021 *Senior Research Fellow*, ERC project "Knowledge, Information Technology, & the Arabic Book" (KITAB), PI Prof. Dr. Sarah Bowen Savant, Aga Khan University–London, Institute for the Study of Muslim Civilisations

2017–2021 *Universitätsassistent für Digital Humanities*, Universität Wien, Institut für Geschichte

2015–2017 *Research Fellow*, Universität Leipzig, Institut für Informatik, Lehrstuhl für Digital Humanities

2013–2015 *Postdoctoral Associate*, Tufts University, Department of Classics & Perseus Project

2006–2012 *Graduate Student Instructor*, University of Michigan, Department of Near Eastern Studies

2004–2006 *Junior Researcher*, Institute of Oriental Manuscripts of the Russian Academy of Sciences (formerly St. Petersburg Branch of the Institute of Oriental Studies), St. Petersburg (IOM RAS)

Education

2006–2013 Ph.D. (December 2013) and M.A. (April 2010) in Near Eastern Studies (Arabic & Islamic Studies), University of Michigan, Ann Arbor (official record)

2001–2004 Post-graduate program in Islamic Studies, Institute of Oriental Manuscripts of the Russian Academy of Sciences, St. Petersburg

1999–2001 St. Petersburg State University, Faculty of Oriental Studies (History of the Arab Countries)

1998–2001 Specialist in Sociology (B.A. & M.A. equivalent), St. Petersburg State University, Faculty of Sociology

1999–2001 Baltic State Technical University, Faculty of Humanities (Political Science), St. Petersburg

Digital Humanities Projects

2021–2027 **EIS1600: The Evolution of Islamic Societies (c. 600–1600 CE): Algorithmic Analysis into Social History.** Emmy Noether Junior Research Group, DFG (#445975300), Universität Hamburg. Principal investigator. Project page · eis1600.aai.uni-hamburg.de

2014– **OpenITI: Open Islamicate Texts Initiative** (2014–2016: OpenArabic). Co-PI with Matthew T. Miller (University of Maryland) and Sarah Bowen Savant (Aga Khan University–London). About 8,700 titles by over 3,300 authors, some 861 million words (most conservatively; all texts amount to 2.4 billion words). Project page · github.com/OpenITI

2014– **OpenITI mARkdown.** A light-weight annotation scheme for Arabic-script texts: structural, morphological, and semantic tagging designed as a research method rather than an exchange format. Description

2014– **al-Ṯurayyā Project.** A gazetteer (over 2,000 toponyms) and a geospatial model of the early Islamic world, with Masoumeh Seydi. Project page · althurayya.github.io

2025 **OpenITI NgramReader** and **Book Classification** (T10 model; published as "M10 Book Classification"). Two online applications published as appendices to *Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies* (Brill, 2026). Project page

2019– **OpenITI AOCP: Arabic-script OCR Catalyst Project.** Co-led with Matthew T. Miller, Sarah Bowen Savant, David Smith, and Raffaele Viglianti; funded by the Andrew W. Mellon Foundation. openiti.org

2018–2021 **KITAB: Knowledge, Information Technology, and the Arabic Book.** ERC project (PI Sarah Bowen Savant); senior research fellow responsible for corpus development and text-reuse analysis. kitab-project.org

2015 **Classical Arabic Through the Words of the Prophet: A Frequency-Based Ḥadīṯ Reader.** Computationally generated teaching materials (Perseus Project & Department of Classics, Tufts University). PDF

Publications

key = key contribution to digital humanities in the field · pr = peer-reviewed · oa = open access

books

2026 new ***Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies: A Proposition for the Field***. Handbook of Oriental Studies, Section 1: The Near and Middle East, vol. 199. Leiden and Boston: Brill, 2026. E-book (PDF) published 1 September 2026, ISBN 978-90-04-76053-0; hardback 1 October 2026, ISBN 978-90-04-76052-3. [**key**, pr] » Brill (order or read online) · Online supplement: figures (figshare, open) · Appendix 1: NgramReader · Appendix 2: Book Classification (T10)

other contributions to arabic and islamic studies

2012 ***Суфизм: руководство для начинающего***. William C. Chittick. Translated from English by **Maxim Romanov** and Yanis Eshots. Moscow: Vostochnaya literatura, 2012. 245 pp. Russian translation of *Sufism: A Beginner's Guide*.

2008 ***Шестой столп ислама. Запрещение осуждаемого***. Michael Cook. Translated from English, edited, and indexed by **Maxim Romanov**. Moscow and St. Petersburg: Dilya, 2008. 346 pp. Series «Ислам: взгляд извне». ISBN 978-5-88503-684-9. Arabic title on the title page: *al-Nahy ʿan al-munkar*. Russian translation of *Forbidding Wrong in Islam: An Introduction* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2003).

2006 ***Арабско-русский словарь к Корану и хадисам***. V. F. Girgas. Revised reprint prepared by Stanislav M. Prozorov and **Maxim Romanov**. St. Petersburg: Dilya, 2006. 928 pp. Arabic–Russian dictionary to the Qur'ān and the ḥadīṯ: a corrected photographic reprint of Girgas's *Словарь к Арабской хрестоматии и Корану* (Kazan, 1881).

2006 ***Мусульманское предание: введение в хадисоведение***. John Burton. Translated from English by S. A. Zhdanov and **Maxim Romanov**; scholarly editing and indexes by **Maxim Romanov**. St. Petersburg: Dilya, 2006. 304 pp. ISBN 5-88503-461-3. Russian translation of *An Introduction to the Hadith* (Edinburgh: Edinburgh University Press, 1994).

2006 ***Мухаммад в Мекке***. W. Montgomery Watt. Translated from English by M. E. Rezvan and N. S. Terletskii; editing (with M. E. Rezvan) and indexes by **Maxim Romanov**. St. Petersburg: Dilya, 2006. 272 pp. ISBN 5-88503-507-5. Russian translation of *Muhammad at Mecca* (Oxford, 1953).

2005 ***Кораністика: введение***. Richard Bell and W. Montgomery Watt. Translated from English by S. A. Zhdanov, B. V. Norik, and **Maxim Romanov**; indexes by **Maxim Romanov**; scholarly editor V. S. Rybalkin. St. Petersburg: Dilya, 2005. 256 pp. Russian translation of *Bell's Introduction to the Qur'ān* (Edinburgh: Edinburgh University Press, 1970).

2004 ***Мусульманский мистицизм: краткая история***. Alexander D. Knysh. Translated from English, with indexes, by **Maxim Romanov**. St. Petersburg: Dilya, 2004. 464 pp. ISBN 5-88503-232-7. Russian translation of *Islamic Mysticism: A Short History* (Leiden: Brill, 2000).

articles and book chapters

2019 **1001 Morphological Patterns: Algorithmically Generated Materials for Teaching Classical Arabic**. In *Innovations and Traditions in Arabic and Islamic Studies: A Festschrift in Honor of Professor Oleg I. Red'kin*, 262–274. St. Petersburg: St. Petersburg University Press, 2019. [pr] » PDF · Publisher

2019 **Studying the History of the Arabic Language: Language Technology and a Large-Scale Historical Corpus**. Yonatan Belinkov*, Alexander Magidow*, Alberto Barrón-Cedeño, Avi Shmidman, and **Maxim Romanov** (* equal contribution). *Language Resources and Evaluation* 53 (2019): 771–805. Springer. [pr] » DOI · PDF (author version)

2018 **A Digital Humanities for Premodern Islamic History**. Roundtable on Digital Humanities, *International Journal of Middle East Studies* 50, no. 1 (2018): 129–134. Cambridge University Press. [**key**, pr] » DOI · PDF · Read as a note

2018 **Digitizing the Textual Heritage of the Premodern Islamicate World: Principles and Plans**. Matthew Thomas Miller, **Maxim G. Romanov**, and Sarah Bowen Savant (alphabetically). Roundtable on Digital Humanities, *International Journal of Middle East Studies* 50, no. 1 (2018): 103–109. Cambridge University Press. [**key**, pr] » DOI · PDF

2017 **Algorithmic Analysis of Medieval Arabic Biographical Collections**. *Speculum* 92, no. S1 (2017): S226–S246. [**key**, pr, oa] » DOI · PDF

2017 **Observations of a Medieval Quantitative Historian?**. *Der Islam* 94, no. 2 (2017): 462–495. [**key**, pr] » DOI · PDF

2017 **Important New Developments in Arabographic Optical Character Recognition (OCR)**. Benjamin Kiessling, Matthew Thomas Miller, **Maxim Romanov**, and Sarah Bowen Savant (alphabetically). *al-ʿUṣūr al-Wusṭá: The Journal of Middle East Medievalists* 25 (2017): 1–13. [**key**, pr, oa] » PDF · Read as a note

2016 **After the Classical World: The Social Geography of Islam (c. 600–1300 CE)**. In *Ars Islamica: Festschrift in Honor of Stanislav Mikhailovich Prozorov*, edited by Mikhail Piotrovsky and Alikber Alikberov, 247–277. Moscow: Vostochnaya Literatura (Russian Academy of Sciences, Institute of Oriental Studies), 2016. [**key**, pr] » PDF

2016 **Digital Age, Digital Methods**. In *Ars Islamica: Festschrift in Honor of Stanislav Mikhailovich Prozorov*, edited by Mikhail Piotrovsky and Alikber Alikberov, 129–156. Moscow: Vostochnaya Literatura (Russian Academy of Sciences, Institute of Oriental Studies), 2016. [pr] » PDF

2016 **Toward Abstract Models for Islamic History**. In *The Digital Humanities and Islamic & Middle East Studies*, edited by Elias Muhanna, 117–149. Berlin: De Gruyter, 2016. ISBN 978-3-11-037454-4. [**key**, pr] » PDF · DOI

2014 **Toward the Digital History of the Pre-Modern Muslim World: Developing Text-Mining Techniques for the Study of Arabic Biographical Collections**. In *Analysis of Ancient and Medieval Texts and Manuscripts: Digital Approaches*, edited by Tara L. Andrews and Caroline Macé, 229–244. Turnhout: Brepols, 2014. [pr] » DOI · PDF

2012 **Dreaming Ḥanbalites: Dream-Tales in Prosopographical Dictionaries**. In *Dreams and Visions in Islamic Societies*, edited by Özgen Felek and Alexander Knysh, 31–50. Albany: SUNY Press, 2012. ISBN 978-1-4384-3993-8. [pr] » PDF

2007 **The Term *Ṣūfī*: Spiritualizing Simple Words**. *Pismennyie Pamyatniki Vostoka / Written Monuments of the Orient* 5 (2007): 149–159. [pr] » PDF

2005 **Electronic Databases on Islam in Arabic, Persian, and English: A Review**. Stanislav M. Prozorov and **Maxim Romanov**. *Pismennyie Pamyatniki Vostoka / Written Monuments of the*

Orient 2, no. 3 (2005): 240–257. With a summary in English. [pr] » PDF · PDF (IOM RAS)

2004 **The Paradigm of the Science of Ḥadīṯ (*ʿIlm al-ḥadīṯ*).** *Vostok / Oriens* 5 (2004): 5–11. With a summary in English. [pr] » PDF (IOM RAS)

2009 ***Ḥadīṯ* Reports in Ibn al-Jawzī's (d. 597/1201) System of Argumentation, Based on His *Talbīs Iblīs* ("Devil's Delusions").** *Khristianskii Vostok / Christian Orient*, n.s. 5 (XI) (2009): 310–316. Moscow: Indrik (Russian Academy of Sciences and the State Hermitage). Accepted for publication in 2003. [pr] » PDF · PDF (IOM RAS)

2003 **Principles and Procedures of Extracting and Processing Data from Arabic Sources: Historical and Biographical Sources**. Stanislav M. Prozorov and **Maxim Romanov**. *Vostok / Oriens* 4 (2003): 117–127. With a summary in English. [pr] » PDF · PDF (IOM RAS)

conference papers, proceedings, and posters

2023 **Enhancing State-of-the-Art NLP Models for Classical Arabic**. Tariq Yousef, Lisa Mischer, Hamid Reza Hakimi, and **Maxim Romanov**. In *Proceedings of the Ancient Language Processing Workshop* (RANLP 2023, Varna, 8 September 2023), 160–169. [pr, oa] » PDF (proceedings) · ACL Anthology

2022 **Establishing Parameters for Stylometric Authorship Attribution of 19th-Century Arabic Books and Periodicals**. Till Grallert and **Maxim Romanov**. In *Digital Humanities 2022: Book of Abstracts* (University of Tokyo), 346–348. [pr]

2019 **Open Islamicate Texts Initiative: A Machine-Readable Corpus of Texts Produced in the Premodern Islamicate World (poster)**. **Maxim Romanov**, Matthew Thomas Miller, Sarah Bowen Savant, and Masoumeh Seydi. In *Digital Humanities 2019 Conference Papers* (Utrecht University, 9–12 July 2019). [**key**, pr, oa] » Abstract · Poster

2019 **al-Ṭurayyā, the Gazetteer and the Geospatial Model of the Early Islamic World**. **Maxim Romanov** and Masoumeh Seydi. In *Digital Humanities 2019 Conference Papers* (Utrecht University, 9–12 July 2019). [**key**, pr, oa] » Abstract

2019 **Orbis-in-a-Box (OIB): Modeling Historical Geographical Networks (poster)**. **Maxim Romanov**, Masoumeh Seydi, James Baillie, Karl Grossner, and Rainer Simon. In *Digital Humanities 2019 Conference Papers* (Utrecht University, 9–12 July 2019). [**key**, pr, oa] » Abstract · Poster

2017 **Premodern Geographical Description: Data Retrieval and Identification**. Masoumeh Seydi, **Maxim Romanov**, and Chiara Palladino (alphabetically). In *Proceedings of the 11th Workshop on Geographic Information Retrieval (GIR'17)*, 4:1–4:10. New York: ACM Press, 2017. [pr] » DOI · PDF

2016 **Shamela: A Large-Scale Historical Arabic Corpus**. Yonatan Belinkov, Alexander Magidow, **Maxim Romanov**, Avi Shmidman, and Moshe Koppel (alphabetically). In *Proceedings of the Workshop on Language Technology Resources and Tools for Digital Humanities (LT4DH)*, 45–53. Osaka, 11–17 December 2016. [pr, oa] » PDF · ACL Anthology

dissertation

2013 ***Computational Reading of Arabic Biographical Collections with Special Reference to Preaching in the Sunnī World (661–1300 CE)***. Ph.D. dissertation, University of Michigan, 2013. [**key**] » Deep Blue (U of Michigan) · PDF (46 MB) · Read as a note

working papers, preprints, and teaching materials

2017 **Algorithmic Analysis of Medieval Arabic Biographical Collections (preprint)**. Leipzig University, May 2017. Published in *Speculum* 92 (2017). » PDF · Published version

2016 **Observations of a Medieval Quantitative Historian? (preprint)**. Leipzig University, September 2016. Published in *Der Islam* 94 (2017). » PDF · Published version

2015 ***Classical Arabic Through the Words of the Prophet: A Frequency-Based Ḥadīṯ Reader***. Perseus Project & Department of Classics, Tufts University, 2015. A computationally gener-

ated introduction to the language of Ḥadīṯ (205 pages). [**key**] » PDF · How it was made

2014 **After the Classical World: The Social Geography of Islam (661–1300 CE) (working paper)**. Tufts University, April 2014. Published in *Ars Islamica* (2016). » PDF · Published version

data, software, and digital publications

2023 **OpenITI: A Machine-Readable Corpus of Islamicate Texts, Primary Version 2023.1.8**. Lorenz Nigst, **Maxim Romanov**, Sarah Bowen Savant, Masoumeh Seydi, and Peter Verkinderen. Zenodo, 2023. Data set. About 8,700 unique titles by over 3,300 authors; some 861 million words (2.4 billion with all versions). [**key**] » DOI · GitHub · Documentation

2025 **ADHFAIS Appendix 1: OpenITI NgramReader (based on OpenITI, release 2023.1.8), version 1**. Zenodo, 2025. An online application for tracing the use of words and phrases across the Arabic written tradition; companion to *Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies*. [**key**] » Application · DOI

2025 **ADHFAIS Appendix 2: M10 Book Classification (based on OpenITI, release 2023.1.8), version 1**. Zenodo, 2025. An experiment in soft classification of the works of the Arabic written tradition against ten types of texts. The application uses the T10 typological model of the book; "M10" in the published title is the same model (M for model). [**key**] » Application · DOI

2014 ongoing **al-Ṯurayyā Project: Gazetteer and Geospatial Model of the Early Islamic World**. **Maxim Romanov** and Masoumeh Seydi. althurayya.github.io. Over 2,000 toponyms and route sections georeferenced from Georgette Cornu's *Atlas du monde arabo-islamique à l'époque classique*. [**key**] » Website

2014 ongoing **OpenITI mARkdown: A Light-Weight Annotation Scheme for Arabic-Script Texts**. Structural, morphological, and semantic tagging designed as a research method; the format of the OpenITI corpus. [**key**] » Description · Editor highlighting (Kate)

2015 **betaCode for Arabic: Conversion Routines**. Python scripts for typing fully vocalized Arabic in ASCII and converting it into Arabic script and several transliteration schemes. » GitHub · Read the note

Invited Talks, Guest Lectures, Keynotes

September 2026: Egypt **Why One Manuscript Needs All The Others: The Case for a Unified Arabic Corpus**, Invited lecture at the workshop *Unlocking Arabic Manuscripts: The Potential of Digital Humanities for Egypt's Collections*, Institute of Arab Research and Studies and Freie Universität Berlin, with support from DAAD (COSIMENA) and the German Federal Foreign Office, Cairo, September 27–28, 2026

September 2026: Germany **Digital Scholarly Communications…**, Keynote at *Beyond the Book: Digital Research, Presentation, and Sustainability*, Freie Universität Berlin, Institute of Arabic Studies, September 21–22, 2026 [**keynote**]

June 2026: Spain **Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies: A Proposition for the Field**, Book presentation, invited lecture at the XII Arabic Codicology Summer Course *The Islamic Manuscript Heritage in the El Escorial Collection*, directed by Nuria de Castilla and François Déroche, Real Biblioteca del Monasterio de San Lorenzo de El Escorial, June 2, 2026

May 2026: Netherlands **Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies: A Proposition for the Field**, Book presentation at a workshop organized by Yusuf Çelik, Faculty of Religion and Theology, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, May 13, 2026

December 2025: Austria **Modeling Social History of the Islamic World (c. 600–1600 CE) … with Generative LLMs**, Guest lecture in the *VO DH Ringvorlesung* of Tara Andrews, winter term 2025/26, Universität Wien, December 9, 2025

April 2025: Turkey · online **Islamicate Digital Humanities: What is it and Why Bother?**, Invited Lecture in the course "Special Topics in Digital History", invited by Hasan Umut, April 14, Boğaziçi University, Turkey

November 2024: Germany **Future in the Past: Constructing the Social History of the Premodern Islamic World with Modern Computational Methods**, at *Digital Humanities and Medieval Middle Eastern Texts: Assessments and Perspectives*, November 8, University of Tübingen. Invited by Federico Montinaro

July 2024: Germany **A Corpus-Driven Approach in Religious Studies: A Case Of Islam**, University of Bochum, July 12, 2024

July 2024: Germany **Digital Humanities in the context of Religious Studies**, University of Bochum, July 12, 2024

November 2023: Spain **Teaching Computational Analysis with the 'Prosopografía de ulemas de al-Andalus'**, at Remembering al-Andalus and the Maghrib in the Mashriq, 23–24 November 2023, Escuela de Estudios Árabes, CSIC, Granada (Spain)

October 2023: Germany **Arabic biographical collections as a source for modeling social transformations, cultural production, and demography**, at Demography, Economy and Law in (Post-)Imperial Worlds 800 to 1600 – Latin Europe and the Western Islamic World in Comparison, Workshop, at RomanIslam Center, Universität Hamburg, October 17, 2023

April 2022: Germany **Made by People, Tied by People: Modeling Islamic Urban Networks from Biographical Data (ca. 600–1300 CE)**, Invited Lecture at RomanIslam Center, April 20, 2022

April 2022: USA **To DB or not to DB: LOD-like Approach and Algorithmic Analysis**, at Digital Praxis in the Humanities (lecture series), Yale University, April 11, 2022

September 2021: Germany **Prospects of Middle Eastern Studies in the Context of Digital Humanities**, at Third Summer School in Islamicate Digital Humanities for Scholars in Manuscript Studies, August 30 – September 10, 2021 [**keynote**]

December 2020: France · online **OpenITI mARkdown: Between Method and Standard**, at Étudier et publier les textes arabes avec le numérique, GIS Asie, études africaines et Moyen-Orient et mondes musulmans. December 8–10, 2020.

November 2020: Austria **Computational History and Historiography of the Medieval Islamic World**, an invited lecture in *070227–1 Introduction to Digital Humanities (2020W)*, taught by Tara Andrews, University of Vienna, November 24, 2020

November 2020: Austria **Data Science & Digital Humanities: Modeling Arabic Written Tradition**, an invited lecture in *040172 VU Doing Data Science (MA) (2020W)*, taught by Jan Fabian Ehmke & Yllka Velaj, University of Vienna, January 7, 2020

January 2020: Austria **Algorithmic Analysis into Social History: A Case of Medieval Islamic History**, an invited lecture in *070227 VO Introduction to Digital Humanities (2019W)*, taught by Tara Andrews, University of Vienna, January 7, 2020

September 2019: Spain **"The Marvels of Old in the Digital World": Toward the Methodological Turn in Middle Eastern Studies**, *Knowledge and Power Seminar Series*, Centro de Ciencias Humanas y Sociales, CSIC, Madrid, September 12, 2019

May 2019: Lebanon **"Digital Dust of the Arabic Past": Corpus-Based Research in Arabic & Islamic Studies**, Keynote at Digital Humanities Institute 2019, Beirut, May 3–5, 2019 [**keynote**]

April 2019: Russia **Arabic History & Historiography in the Digital Age**, *invited lecture* at Higher School of Economics, St.Petersburg

February 2019: Hungary **Arabic History & Historiography in the Digital Age**, *invited lecture* at Center for Eastern Mediterranean Studies and OTTOCONFESSIONS, ERC-funded Project (PI Dr. Tijana Krstic), Central European University, Budapest

April 2018: Qatar **"Iftaḥ Yā Simsim!" Finding Digital Keys to the Treasures of the Arabic Written**

Tradition, Keynote at "Research Data Management in Digital Humanities", International Conference, University College London—Doha, April 17–18, 2018 [**keynote**]

February 2018: Austria **"Open Sesame!" Digital Analysis of the Arabic Written Tradition: Part I—On Social History**, Austrian Academy of Sciences, Vienna, February 6, 2018

May 2017: Netherlands **The Corpus, The Network, & The Book Continuum**, the fifth lecture of the KITAB LUCIS lectures (others given by Sarah Savant), Leiden University Centre for the Study of Islam and Society, Leiden University

May 2017: Netherlands **Computational Reading of Arabic Biographical Collections**, *Invited Lecture* at The Leiden University Centre for Digital Humanities (LUCDH), Leiden University

February 2017: USA **Premodern Arabic Biographical Collections: A Digital Approach**, *Invited Lecture* at University of Pennsylvania

2017: Germany **Arabic Written Tradition & the Digital Humanities**, Invited lecture, given at Universität Hamburg (April 24, 2017) and Goethe-Universität Frankfurt am Main (March 24, 2017)

November 2016: USA **From Text to Map: Arabic Biographical Collections and Geospatial Analysis**, *Invited Lecture*, at Center for Geographic Analysis, Harvard University

June 2016: Germany **Future in the Past: Using Modern Computational Methods for the Analysis of Premodern Arabic Texts**, *guest lecture* at "Society and Religion in the Arab World" (an introductory Arabic and Islamic Studies seminar taught by Marie Hakenberg), Leipzig University

May 2016: Germany **Annotation of Geographical Data**, With Chiara Palladino; Session 14 of Sunoikisis Digital Classics 2016

April 2016: Germany/USA **Discovering Spatial and Chronological Patterns in Historical Texts**, *invited lecture* at Unlocking the Digital Humanities, A Seminar organized by Leipzig University & Tufts University, Spring 2016

2016: USA **Writing a 50-volume book in 14th-century Damascus: Algorithmic Analysis, Text Reuse & the Arabic Written Tradition**, Invited lecture, given at Davidson College (November 9, 2016) and the University of Michigan (March 10, 2016)

December 2015: USA/Netherlands **Arabic and Islamic Studies and the Digital Humanities**, The Brill Workshop on the Digital Humanities, Leiden (December 2–3) and Boston (May 1–2)

February 2015: USA **Digital Humanities & the Premodern Islamic World: Of Graphs, Maps, and 30,000 Muslims**, Invited public lecture, The Gustav E. von Grunebaum Center for Near Eastern Studies, University of California—Los Angeles, February 25, 2015

2015–2016: USA/Germany/UK **Of Graphs, Maps, and 30,000 Muslims: Premodern Arabic Texts & the Digital Humanities**, Invited lecture, given in different versions at the Center for Digital Humanities / Department of History, University of South Carolina (November 14, 2016); Duke University (November 11, 2016); University of Tübingen (May 11, 2016); MITH, University of Maryland (March 2, 2016); University of St Andrews (November 27, 2015); University of Manchester (November 25, 2015); SOAS, University of London (November 23, 2015)

August 2014: USA **The Social Geography of the Islamic World (661–1300 CE): on the Method**, *invited talk* at PROSOP Workshop, Florida State University, Tallahassee, FL (August 15, 2014)

April 2014: USA **Distant Reading of Arabic Biographical Collections**, *guest lecture* at "Saints and Sinners in Muslim Literature" (Mimi Hanaoka) at the University of Richmond, Richmond, VA (April 10, 2014)

April 2014: USA **The Social Geography of the Islamic World (661–1300 CE)**, *invited talk* at the University of Richmond, Richmond, VA (April 10, 2014)

April 2014: USA **Future in the Past: Using Digital Methods to Study Medieval Arabic Texts**, *brown bag lecture* at Tufts University (April 7, 2014).

April 2014: USA **Classical Arabic through the Words of the Prophet: Teaching Classical Arabic in**

the Digital Age, *brown bag lecture* at Tufts University (April 2, 2014).

March 2014: USA **Studying Classical Arabic Sources in the Digital Age: Social Geography & Social History**, *invited talk* at Holy Cross Manuscripts, Inscriptions and Documents Club the College of the Holy Cross, Worcester, MA (March 14, 2014)

February 2014: USA **Building a Historical Gazetteer**, *Guest Lecture* at "Computational methods in the humanities," An honors course (Prof. David J. Birnbaum) at the University of Pittsburgh, Pittsburgh, PA (February, 21, 2014)

February 2014: USA **Connectedness of the Islamic World (661–1300 CE)**, *invited talk* at the European Union Center of Excellence & European Studies Center, the University of Pittsburgh, Pittsburgh, PA (February, 20, 2014)

2014: USA **Computational Reading of Classical Arabic Sources: the Case of Biographical Collections**, Invited talk, given at the Department of Classics, Tufts University (March 10, 2014); Bard College, Annandale-on-Hudson, NY (February 11, 2014); and the Center for Digital Research in the Humanities, University of Nebraska–Lincoln (January 30, 2014)

Conference Papers and Presentations

July 2026: Belgium **Out of How Many? Numerator Without / With Denominator**, at the Seventeenth Meeting of the School of Abbasid Studies, KU Leuven, July 14–18, 2026

October 2024: UK **Navigating Seas of Biographies: A Computational Pipeline for Biography Identification in Historical Corpora (EIS1600 Project Paper)**, together with Alicia González Martínez (*delivered the presentation*), Tariq Yousef, and Hamid Reza Hakimi, at the *Arabic Pasts 2024: Histories and Historiographies*, October 3–5, 2024, at Aga Khan University, Institute for the Study of Muslim Civilizations.

September 2024: Germany **Data-Driven Periodization of Classical Arabic and the Arabic Written Tradition**, at the *Societies in Transition: Law, Culture and Politics in the Middle East (30th International DAVO Congress)*, University of Göttingen, September 26–28, 2024

September 2024: Germany **A Book of 30,000 Biographies: Computational Analysis of Sources of "The History of Islam" of al-Ḏahabī (d. 748/1348)**, at *Textual Transmission in the Islamic Manuscript Age: On the Variance, Reception, and Usage of Arabic and Persian Works from the Middle East to the Indian Subcontinent*, German-Japanese Bilateral Conference, University of Münster, September 5–7, 2024

August 2024: Armenia **Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies: what is it and why bother?**, at *Texts, Interpretations, and Entanglements in the Study of Islamicate History*, International Conference at the Yerevan State University, August 28–30, 2024

June 2024: USA **Modeling Social History: A Deep Learning Approach to Arabic Historical Tradition**, together with Alicia González Martínez, Tariq Yousef (*delivered the presentation*), and Hamid Reza Hakimi, at *DH 2024: Reinvention & Responsibility*, the annual conference of the Alliance of Digital Humanities Organizations, at The Roy Rosenzweig Center for History and New Media, Arlington, VA / Washington, D.C., August 6–9, 2024, Published: <https://tinyurl.co MSH>.

June 2024: Germany **Text Reuse in the Arabic Written Tradition: A Case of Biographical Collections**, at *Making of a Sage: Corpora of Wise Sayings in a Religio-Historical Perspective*, International Workshop at Göttingen University, organized by Ute Pietruschka, June 28–29, 2024

March 2024: UAE **Computational typology of texts as a means of modeling the development of the Arabic written tradition**, at *The Praxis of Digital Humanities: Expanding Horizons and Transforming Scholarship in the Arab/Islamic world*, a symposium, March 6–7, 2024, Department of Arabic and Translation Studies (ATS), American University of Sharjah (AUS)

December 2023: Japan **Ṣundūq al-ġarāʾib fī-l-ʿaṣr al-raqāʾim: Reading Medieval Texts in the Digital Age**, at The Middle East and Europe, 1097–1517, Waseda University, Tokyo, 9–10 December,

2023

October 2023: UK **Modelling the Development of Premodern Islamic Societies from Biographical and Historical Data**, (together with: Hamid Reza Hakimi, Lisa Mischer, and Tariq Yousef), at Arabic Pasts 2023, 5–6 October 2023, Aga Khan University—London

September 2023: Bulgaria **Enhancing State-of-the-Art NLP Models for Classical Arabic**, together with Tariq Yousef, Lisa Mischer (*delivered presentation*), and Hamid Reza Hakimi, at Ancient Language Processing Workshop, at Recent Advances in Natural Language Processing, September 8, Varna, Bulgaria

June 2023: USA **OpenITI `mARkdown`: Balancing Between a Standard and a Research Method**, at Digital Publication of Right-to-Left Script Corpora, June 29–30, 2023; The University of Maryland, College Park, MD, USA

June 2023: Germany **Finding and Linking Information in Arabic Historical Texts**, (together with Lisa Mischer, Hamid Reza Hakimi, Tariq Yousef), at Data Linking Workshop 2023: Computer Vision and Natural Language Processing – Challenges in the Humanities, Center for the Study of Manuscript Cultures, Universität Hamburg, June 27–28, 2023

March 2023: Germany **Algorithmic Analysis into Social History**, at LOOP Workshop, Ruhr Universität Bochum, March, 9–10, 2023

September 2022: Germany **Similarity-Based Networks for Islamicate Digital Humanities**, at "Computational Contributions to the Social and Cultural Histories of the Islamicate World", *a Panel*, co-organized with Till Grallert, at 34. Deutscher Orientalistentag 12.-17.09.2022, Freie Universität Berlin (100 Jahre DOT)

July 2022: Germany **Modeling the Development of Premodern Islamic Societies through Computational Analysis of Written Sources**, at Linked Open Tafsir Conference 2022, July 18 -20, 2022, Bad Homburg, Germany

October 2021: Germany **Being Pragmatic: Data and Authority Files in the OpenITI Corpus**, at <AUTHOR><TITLE Authority Records and Manuscripts in Libraries and Research (hybrid workshop), a workshop co-organised by the "Orient-Digital" project at Berlin State Library and "Bibliotheca Arabica" (Saxon Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Leipzig) October 27–29, 2021

October 2021: online **OpenITI: The Corpus for The Field**, at "Digitalizing Humanities. Humanizing digitalization", online congress, organized by Enrique Capdevila (*Petrifying Wealth*-IH) and Arturo Guerrero (*EuQu*-ILC), October 20–21, 2021

October 2020: USA · online **One Source to Rule Them All: Constructing the Master Chronicle for Islamic History**, at Middle East Studies Association 54th Annual Meeting (online), October 5–17, 2020

October 2020: USA · online **Big Data and Mega Corpora in the Middle East Studies: The Case of Arabic Written Tradition**, at Middle East Studies Association 54th Annual Meeting (online), October 5–17, 2020

August 2020: Germany · online **Digital Humanities with non-European sources: The Case of Arabic**, at "Hack the Middle East": an Introduction to Digital Humanities, an Online Workshop, *Die Junge Akademie*, August 11–12, 2020

July 2020: Germany · online **OpenITI**, at Digitalisierungsworkshop der orientalistischen Fächer BA/ER (Workshop on Digital Tools in Oriental Studies BA/ER), Universität Bamberg & Universität Erlangen, July 4, 2020

October 2019: USA/UK **Something Old, Something New, Something Borrowed: Computational Analysis of Writing Practices of Islamic Scholars**, at: • Middle East Studies Association 53rd Annual Meeting, November 14–17, New Orleans, LA, USA; • Arabic Pasts: Histories and Historiography, 17–19 October 2019, Aga Khan University, London

July 2019: Netherlands **Open Islamicate Texts Initiative: A Machine-Readable Corpus of Texts Produced in the Premodern Islamicate World**, at Digital Humanities 2019, Utrecht University,

July 9–12 (In collaboration with: Matthew Thomas Miller, Sarah Bowen Savant, and Masoumeh Seydi)

July 2019: Netherlands **al-Ṯurayyā, the Gazetteer and the Geo-Spatial Model of the Early Islamic World**, at Digital Humanities 2019, Utrecht University, July 9–12 (In collaboration with: Masoumeh Seydi, who also presented)

July 2019: Netherlands **Orbis-in-a-box (OIB): Modeling Historical Geographical Networks**, at Digital Humanities 2019, Utrecht University, July 9–12 (In collaboration with: Masoumeh Seydi, James Ballie, Karl Grossner, and Rainer Simon)

June 2019: Japan · online **Computational Historiography: al-Ḏahabī's *Taʾrīḫ al-islām* and His Sources**, at the Sixth Conference of the *School of Mamluk Studies*, Tokyo, Japan, June 15–17 2019

April 2019: Russia **Interconnectedness of Texts and Computational Modeling of the Arabic Written tradition**, (*in Russian*: "Преемственность текстов и компьютерное моделирование арабской письменной традиции"), at The 41st Annual Session of St Petersburg Arabists, The Institute of Oriental Manuscripts of the Russian Academy of Sciences. April 8–10, 2019.

February 2019: UK **Modeling Society from Text: a Method in Arabic Studies**, at Decoding the Past. Digital Tools for the Analysis of Historical Data, *a Workshop*, University of London, February 21–22, 2019

December 2018: Spain **al-Ḏahabī's treatment of his Andalusi sources: toward understanding of compilation methods of medieval historians**, at *The Maghrib in the Mashriq* (i.e.: *Islamic West in Islamic East*), a congress, Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Madrid, 20–21 December 2018

December 2018: Netherlands **Prospects of Corpus-Based Research: Computational Methods and the OpenITI Corpus**, at *Whither Islamicate Digital Humanities*, Academy Colloquium, The Royal Netherlands Academy of Arts and Sciences, Amsterdam, 13–15 December 2018 (organized by Christian Lange & Melle Lyklema, Utrecht University)

May 2018: Italy **Modeling Arabic Written Tradition: Enhancing Traditional Text analysis with Computational Techniques**, at *Launching RASCIO: Reader, Author, Scholar in Context of Information Overflow*, a Workshop organized by Dr. Élise Franssen, Università Ca' Foscari Venezia, May 24, 2018

November 2017: USA **Looking for the author behind the words: Stylometric Analysis of al-Ḏahabī's (d. 1347) Writings**, at *A New Corpus for the Islamicate World and Methods for Its Exploration*, a Panel co-organized by Sarah Savant and Matthew Miller, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C.

October 2017: Austria **Modeling Social History of the Premodern Islamic World**, at Evolution of Social Complexity, a Workshop organized by Complexity Science Hub Vienna, October 2–3, 2017

September 2017: Spain **Digital Humanities in the field of Islamic studies**, at Digital Humanities & the History of al-Andalus and the Maghreb: Challenges and Opportunities, a Research Seminar at Escuela de Estudios Árabes—Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas (CSIC), Cuesta del Chapiz, 22, Granada

May 2017: Italy **Why do we need a corpus and computational methods?**, at Navigating the House of Wisdom: How to write a good book in the medieval Middle East, a Workshop at the University of Milan, May 25th-26th 2017.

April 2017: United Arab Emirates **Algorithmic Analysis of Premodern Arabic Biographical Collections: Approach, Infrastructure, Open Data**, at Digital Humanities Abu Dhabi—DHAD, a Workshop at New York University Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates, 10–12 April 2017

January 2017: Germany **80/20: Facilitating Computational Analysis with Named-Entities Recognition**, at Digital Infrastructure for Named Entities Data, a Workshop, Leipzig University, January 11–13, 2017

December 2016: Spain **An Accidental Gazetteer: Linked Data for Historical Geography of the Classical**

Islamic World, at Linked Pasts 2016, a symposium series dedicated to facilitating practical and pragmatic developments in Linked Open Data in History, Classics, Geography and Archaeology, December 15–16, 2016 (hosted at: Universidad Nacional de Educación a Distancia, Madrid)

November 2016: USA **Of A Network and A Node: 'The History of Islam' of al-Ḏahabī (d. 1348) and its place in the Premodern Arabic Textual Tradition**, at *Networked Texts: New Ways of Seeing the Arabic Textual Tradition (750–1500)*, a Panel co-organized by Sarah Savant and Maxim Romanov, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, Boston, MA

September 2016: USA **Presentation on Islamic[ate] DH Projects at Leipzig University**, at Activism, Advocacy, and Scholarship on Islam in the Digital Realm: Prospects, Progress, and Challenges, a workshop organized by the Institute for the Study of Muslim Societies & Civilizations, Boston University (September 16 & 17, 2016)

October 2015: USA **"al-Ḏahabī's Monster": Dissecting a 50-Volume Arabic Chronicle-cum-Biographical Collection from the 14th Century CE**, at *Distant Reading & the Islamic Archive*, Conference at Brown University, October 16, 2015

September 2015: UK **The *Taʾrīḫ al-islām* of al-Ḏahabī (d. 748/1347 CE): Computational Exploration of the Life-Cycle of a 50-Volume Arabic Chronicle-cum-Biographical Collection**, at Arabic Pasts: Histories and Historiographies: Research Workshop, co-hosted by the Aga Khan University, Institute for the Study of Muslim Civilisations and SOAS, University of London (September 25–26, 2015)

July 2015: USA **Cultural Production in the Islamic World (600–1900 CE): mining an Ottoman bibliographical collection from the early 20th century**, at The Keystone Digital Humanities Conference, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA (July 22–24, 2015)

May 2015: USA **Analyzing Arabic Biographical Collections at Scale**, at Digital Ottoman Platform Workshop, Institute for Advanced Study, Princeton, NJ (June 8–12, 2015)

May 2015: USA **The Writing Culture of Nīshāpūr in the 11th Century**, [In collaboration with Sarah Savant, Aga Khan University, London; paper delivered by Sarah Savant], at Iranian Cities from the Arab Conquest to the Early Modern Period, Harvard University, Cambridge, MA (May 1–2).

November 2014: USA **Exploring Islamic Written Legacy: Computational Reading of *Hadiyyat al-ʿārifīn***, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C.

March 2014: USA **Computational Processing of Toponymic Data from classical Arabic Sources**, at Working with Text in a Digital Age, A Workshop at Tufts University (the Perseus Project) (March 29, 2014).

February 2014: USA **Visualizing Islamic Geography at Scale**, at Data Big and Small: Computer Science, the Humanities and Social Science: Conversations between representatives from Leipzig, Northeastern, Princeton & Tufts, a workshop at Tufts University (the Perseus Project) (February 3–4, 2014).

October 2013: USA **Abstract Models for Islamic History**, at Digital Humanities and Islamic & Middle Eastern Studies, Brown University, Providence, RI (October 24–25, 2013).

October 2013: USA **Islamic World Connected (661–1300 CE)**, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA.

April 2013: USA **Toward Abstract Models for Islamic History**, Poster at *Word, Space, Time: Digital Perspectives on the Classical World*, an interdisciplinary conference organized by the Digital Classics Association, University at Buffalo, SUNY, April 5–6, 2013

March 2013: USA **Exploratory Analysis of Arabic Biographical Collections: the Case of al-Ḏahabī's (d. 1347 CE) *Taʾrīḫ al-islām***, at: • the 223rd Meeting of the American Oriental Society (AOS), Portland, OR; • the 8th Annual Pearl Kibre Medieval Study Conference: "New Media and the Middle Ages", The Graduate Center, CUNY, New York, NY.

February 2013: USA **«Connectedness» of the Islamic World (600–1300 CE)**, at 7th Annual Near Eastern Studies Graduate Student Colloquium, U of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI.

November 2012: USA **Social History of the Muslim World in the Digital Age: Making Sense of 29,000 Biographies from al-Ḏahabī's «History of Islam»**, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, Denver, CO.

November 2012: USA **Social History of the Muslim World in the Digital Age: Making Sense of 29,000 Biographies from al-Ḏahabī's «History of Islam»**, at Cyberinfrastructure Days, University of Michigan, November 7–8, 2012. Received: "People's Choice Award Winner"

October 2012: USA **Writing the Digital History of the Premodern Muslim World, 670–1300 CE: Exploratory Analysis of Primary Sources**, at Interdisciplinary Workshop under the rubric "Forum on Research in Medieval Studies" (FoRMS), the Medieval Lunch Series, University of Michigan.

August 2012: USA **Mining pre-Modern Islamic Sources**, at "Working with Text in a Digital Age," the summer institute at Tufts U, Medford, MA.

April 2012: Russia **Dreaming Ḥanbalites: Dream-Tales in Prosopographical Dictionaries**, (in Russian), at the 34th Annual Session of St. Petersburg Arabists, SPbIOS/IOM of RAS.

April 2012: Belgium **Digital History of the Muslim World: Computer-Aided Analysis of Biographical Dictionaries**, at Methods and means for digital analysis of ancient and medieval texts and manuscripts, a workshop at the Katholieke Universiteit, Leuven & the Royal Flemish Academy of Belgium (KVAB), Brussels.

November 2010: USA **«Popular» Preaching in the Sunnī Context and the Legitimization of *Waʿẓ* in the Late 12th Century CE**, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, San Diego, CA.

November 2009: USA **Aḥmad b. Ḥanbal's (d. 241/855) Argumentative Strategies**, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, Boston, MA.

April 2009: USA **Dreaming Ḥanbalites**, at Dreams and Visions in Islamic Societies, conference, University of Michigan.

March 2004: Russia **The Origins of the Term *Ṣūfī***, (in Russian), at the 26th Annual Session of St. Petersburg Arabists, SPbIOS/IOM of RAS.

December 2003: Russia **The Paradigm of the Science of Ḥadīṯ (*ʿIlm al-ḥadīṯ*)**, (in Russian), at the Annual Academic Session, SPbIOS/IOM of RAS.

April 2003: Russia **Argumentation with *Ḥadīṯ* Reports in Ibn al-Jawzī's *Talbīs Iblīs* ("Devil's Delusions")**, (in Russian), at the 25th Annual Session of St. Petersburg Arabists, SPbIOS/IOM of RAS

April 2002: Russia **Ibn al-Jawzī's Image in the Western Scholarship**, (in Russian), at the 24th Annual Session of St. Petersburg Arabists, SPbIOS/IOM of RAS.

Panels, Workshops, and Roundtables Organized

July 2025: Germany **From Classical ML to AI in Arabic and Islamic Studies: A Hands-On Workshop**, (part of EIS1600 project activities), a 4-day workshop at *Afrika-Asien Institut*, Universität Hamburg (EIS1600 Project), with Tariq Yousef, Ryan Muther, and Alicia González Martínez. Funding: DFG, EIS1600 Emmy Noether Project

September 2024: Germany **Stylometry and the Digital Humanities: Unraveling Authorship and Periodization in Arabic Textual Traditions**, *a panel* co-organized with Till Grallert and Maroussia Bednarkiewicz at the 30th International Congress of Deutsche Arbeitsgemeinschaft Vorderer Orient (DAVO), Göttingen, 26–28 September 2024

September 2022: Germany **Computational Contributions to the Social and Cultural Histories of the Islamicate World**, *a panel* co-organized with Till Grallert, at: 34. Deutscher Orientalistentag 12.-

17.09.2022, Freie Universität Berlin (100 Jahre DOT)

July 2020: Austria/UK · online **Stylometry Workshop with Maciej Eder**, Department of History, University of Vienna & The KITAB Project, Aga Khan University, London. July 1–3, 2020.

June 2019: Japan **Approaching Mamlūk Historiography: Narratologically, Literarily, Computationally**, a panel at the Sixth Conference of the School of Mamlūk Studies, Waseda University, Tokyo, June 15–17, 2019

July 2018: Austria **ORBIS-esque Hackathon**, Department of History, University of Vienna (co-organized with Tara Andrews and Mária Varga); planning document: tinyurl.com/orbis-esque.

November 2017: USA **A New Corpus for the Islamicate World and Methods for Its Exploration**, *a panel* co-organized with Dr. Sarah Savant (AKU–London) and Dr. Matthew Thomas Miller (UMD) at MESA, Washington, DC–2017

November 2016: USA **Networked Texts: New Ways of Seeing the Arabic Textual Tradition (750–1500)**, *a panel* co-organized with Dr. Sarah Savant (AKU–London), MESA, Boston–2016

November 2016: USA **Non-traditional methods for Teaching Traditional Languages**, *a roundtable* at the annual meeting of the Middle East Studies Association (MESA), Boston 2016

December 2015: Germany **Analyzing Text Reuse at Scale / Working with Big Humanities Data**, at Leipzig University, organized by Thomas Köntges & Maxim Romanov (within the framework of Leipzig Workshop Week, 14–18 December 2015).

December 2015: Germany **Digital Arabic and Digital Persian Research Workshop**, at Leipzig University, organized by Maxim Romanov (within the framework of Leipzig Workshop Week, 14–18 December 2015).

November 2013: USA **Digital Humanities in Middle East Studies**, (organized together with Børre Ludvigsen and Will Hanley), a series of two panels and a roundtable: "Traditional Sources, Nontraditional Methods," "Digital Communication," and Roundtable at the annual meeting of the Middle East Studies Association (MESA), New Orleans 2013.

November 2010: USA **Islamic Preaching**, *a panel* at the annual meeting of the Middle East Studies Association (MESA), San Diego, 2010

Teaching

2023–2024 **Computational Analysis of Data from Audition Certificates, with R**, Universität Hamburg · Winter 2023/24 · Historical methods · DH » Course site

2023 **Digital Humanities in African-Asian Studies: Analysis of Prosopographical Data with R**, Universität Hamburg · Summer 2023 · Historical methods · DH » Course site

2022 **Text Analysis in R**, Universität Hamburg · Summer 2022 · Historical methods · DH » Course site

2022 **Digital Humanities in Middle Eastern Studies**, Universität Hamburg · Winter 2021/22 · Historical methods · DH » Course site

2021 **GIS Inquiries with R**, University of Vienna · Summer 2021 (SE seminar, PM 3) · GIS · DH » Course site

2017–2020 **DH Methods: Historical Inquiries with R**, University of Vienna · Summer 2020 (text analysis module), Summer 2019, Winter 2017/18 (SE seminar, PM 3) · Historical methods · DH » Course site (2020)

2018–2020 **Tools and Techniques for Digital Humanities**, University of Vienna · Winter 2020, Summer 2019, Summer 2018 (KU Methodenkurs) · DH

2018 **Of Arabs, Persians and Turks: Patterns of Dynastic Rule in the Islamic World (c. 600–1600 CE)**, University of Vienna · Summer 2018 (MA Proseminar) · History

2017–2018 **The Near East at the Time of the First Crusade, 1045–1144**, University of Vienna · Winter 2017/18 (BA Proseminar), co-taught with Tara Andrews · History

2017–2018 **The Medieval Near East and Europe according to Muslims, Christians, and Jews: Comparative Perspectives**, University of Vienna · Winter 2017/18 (seminar), co-taught with Tara Andrews · History

2016–2017 **Islamicate World 2.0: Studying Islamic Cultures through Computational Textual Analysis**, University of Maryland (College Park) and Leipzig University · Winter 2016/17, co-taught with Matthew Thomas Miller · Islamicate texts · DH

2015 **Classical Arabic Through the Words of the Prophet**, Tufts University · Spring 2015 · Classical Arabic · DH

2014–2015 **Introduction to Text Mining for Students of the Humanities**, Tufts University · 2014–2015 · Text analysis · DH

2014 **Mapping the Classical Islamic World**, Tufts University · Winter 2014 · History · DH

2012 **The First Millennium of the Islamic Near East, 600–1600 CE**, University of Michigan · Fall 2012, as teaching assistant for Michael Bonner · History · DH

2010–2011 **Introduction to Islam**, University of Michigan · Spring 2011, Winter 2011 (as teaching assistant for Sherman Jackson), Spring 2010 · Religion · History

2007–2010 **Elementary Modern Standard Arabic**, University of Michigan · 2007–2010 · Language

2006–2007 **Elementary Classical Arabic**, University of Michigan · 2006–2007 · Classical language

Workshops and Summer Schools Taught

June 2026: Spain **Dialogue as Scholarly Practice: the Socratic Method in the Age of AI**, A 2-day workshop for scholars of Arabic, Islamic, and Middle Eastern studies on working with large language models without programming, at the Instituto de Lenguas y Culturas del Mediterráneo y Oriente Próximo (ILC), CCHS-CSIC, Madrid, June 8–9, 2026, with Alicia González Martínez and Hamid Reza Hakimi; the book *Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies* was presented in the closing session

September 2025: Switzerland **Summer School on Digital Humanities for Islamic Studies**, University of Bern, September 1–4, 2025. Organizers: Tobias Hodel and Serena Tolino

July 2025: Germany **From Classical ML to AI in Arabic and Islamic Studies: A Hands-On Workshop**, A 4-day workshop at the Asien-Afrika-Institut, Universität Hamburg, organized within EIS1600 with Tariq Yousef, Ryan Muther, and Alicia González Martínez

September 2024: Germany **Introduction to Digital Humanities in Islamic Studies: A Hands-On Training**, A 1-day workshop at the Seminar für Arabistik/Islamwissenschaft, Universität Göttingen, with Jens Scheiner, September 25, 2024

September 2024: Spain **Computational Analysis of Andalusian Prosopography**, A 5-day workshop on the *Prosopografía de ulemas de al-Andalus* (eea.csic.es/pua) at the Escuela de Estudios Árabes, Granada, with Mayte Penelas and Maribel Fierro, as part of the project *Al-Andalus y el Magrib en el Oriente islámico: movilidad, migración y memoria* (AMOI-II)

December 2023: Japan **Intensive Workshop in Islamic Digital Humanities**, A 2-day workshop organized with Wakako Kumakura, Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, December 16–17, 2023

July 2018: Belgium **Digital Islamic Humanities: A 3-Day Intensive Course**, Ghent University, July 2–4, 2018, in collaboration with the Ghent Centre for Digital Humanities. Plan and materials: dih-sms2018-ughent.github.io

November 2017: Netherlands **Workshop on Digital Humanities in Islamic and Arabic Studies**, SENSIS ERC Project (PI Christian Lange), Utrecht University, November 30–December 1, 2017

July 2016: Germany **From Text to Map**, A two-week intensive introduction (32 contact hours) to working with humanities data in digital mapping environments, co-taught with David J. Wrisley (American University of Beirut) at *Culture & Technology*, the European Summer University in Digital Humanities, Leipzig University

February 2015: USA **Digital Humanities & Islamic Studies**, University of California, Los Angeles. Organized by Asma Sayeed and the Gustav E. von Grunebaum Center for Near Eastern Studies

October 2014: USA **Textual Corpora and the Digital Islamic Humanities**, Brown University; session leader together with Elli Mylonas, organized by Elias Muhanna (details)

Supervision

2025–: Ph.D. **Hamid Reza Hakimi**, *Patterns in the Financial History of the Islamic World (1–1000 AH / 600–1600 CE): Computational Analysis of Data from Chronicles*, Universität Hamburg, African and Asian Studies (main advisor)

2022: M.A. **Lisa Mischer**, *A Digital Humanities Approach to Biographical Dictionaries from the Arabic Written Tradition: Extraction and Enrichment of Historical Data*, Universität Leipzig, Digital Humanities (external advisor)

2022: B.A. **M. Xenia Kudela**, *Measuring Style: Stylometric Analysis of Collaborative Authorship between Ṭāhā Ḥusayn and Tawfīq al-Ḥakīm in "The Enchanted Castle" (al-Qaṣr al-mashūr)*, Freie Universität Berlin, Arabic Studies (external advisor)

2022: Ph.D. **Masoumeh Seydi**, *Geospatial Analysis and Modeling of Textual Descriptions of Pre-modern Geography*, Universität Leipzig, Computer Science / Digital Humanities (external advisor)

2015: B.A. Honors **Cameron Jackson**, *An Interactive Map of the Classical Islamic World*, Tufts University, Computer Science and Arabic Studies

Third-Party Funding

2021–2027 Emmy Noether Programme Grant, German Research Foundation (DFG). About €1,900,000

2012–2013 Charlotte W. Newcombe Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship, Woodrow Wilson National Fellowship Foundation. $24,000

2012 Rackham Research Fellowship, University of Michigan. $3,000

Fellowships, Awards, and Honors

2015–2016 Research Fellowship (Visiting Fellow), Islamic Legal Studies Program, Harvard Law School (declined)

2013 Hajja Razia Sharif Sheikh Scholarship Award in Islamic Studies, University of Michigan

Service to the Field

2021, 2023, 2025 Panel member (SH5 "Cultures and Cultural Production"), ERC Consolidator Grant calls, European Research Council

2015– Reviewer for journals and funding bodies at the intersection of digital humanities, Arabic and Islamic studies, and history. Recent reviews for *Journal of Abbasid Studies*, *Journal of Digital Islamicate Research*, *Digital Scholarship in the Humanities*, *Temenos*, *Journal of Law and Religion*

2013– Regular consultation on the design of digital projects in the historical study of the Islamic world, including over a dozen ERC-funded and academy projects in the US, Canada, the UK, the Netherlands, Belgium, Spain, Italy, Israel, Japan, Austria, and Germany

Professional Membership

2024– Union Européenne des Arabisants et Islamisants (UEAI)

2023– School of Abbasid Studies (SAS)

2016– Middle East Medievalists (MEM)

2012– American Oriental Society (AOS)

2008– Middle East Studies Association (MESA)

Skills

Languages Russian (native) · Arabic (advanced, modern standard and classical) · English (near-native) · German (B1) · French (reading)

Computing R, Python, QGIS, LaTeX; cluster computing; machine learning